

PrepaTec | MONMX Hidalgo 2026

WHO Preparatory

Background

RAÍCES AL FUTURO

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Introduction to the committee:

The World Health OThe World Health Organization (WHO) is the United Nations' specialized agency responsible for coordinating nations in order to achieve goals related to global health. Founded in 1948, it serves as the directing authority in international public health. leading member states to collaborate to set health standards, guide public policy and address challenges around the world.

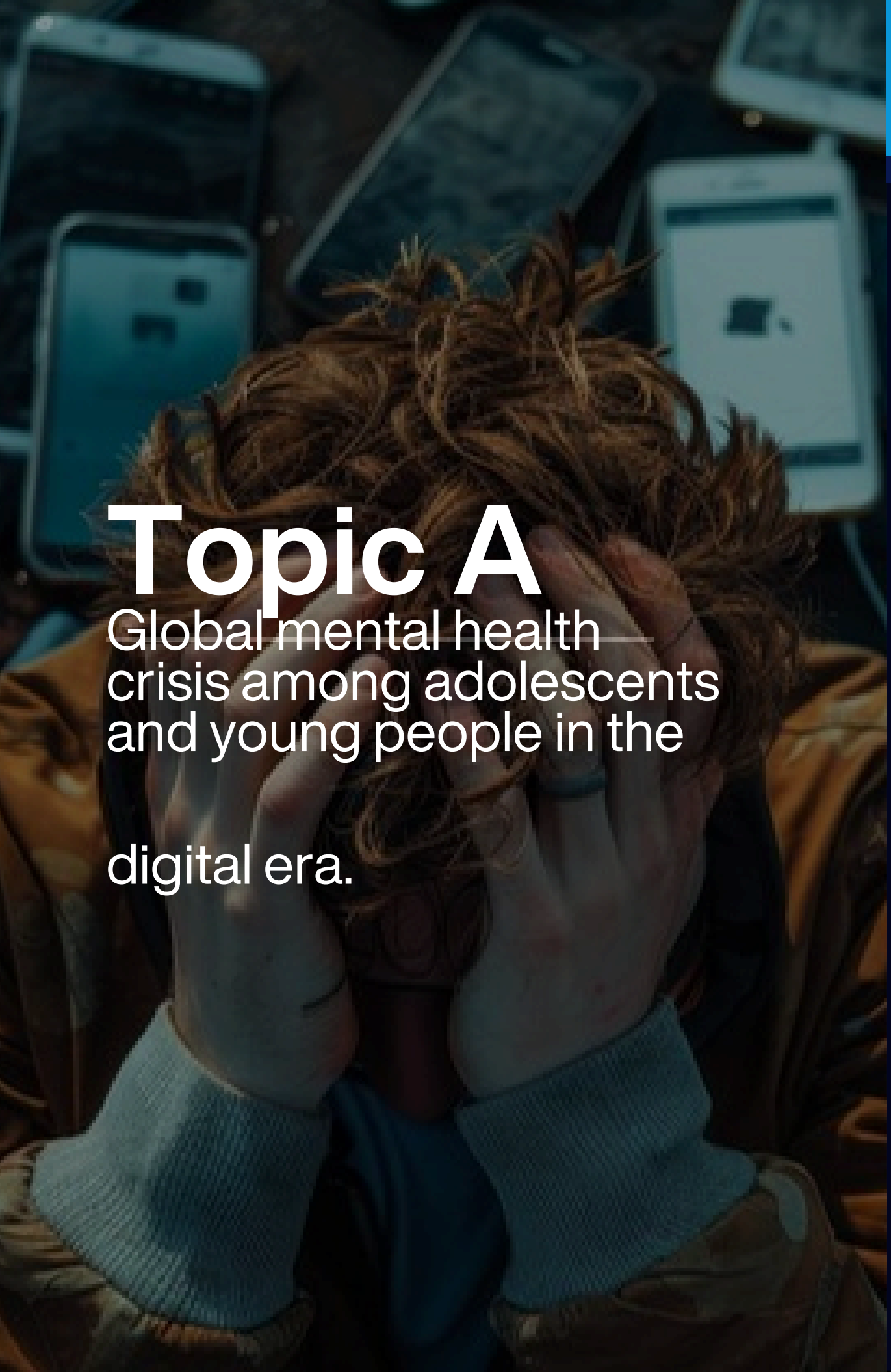
The committee's main purpose is promoting health worldwide, acting as the main authority in health matters, ensuring the highest level of physical, mental and social well- being for everyone. To achieve this, the WHO improves access to essential equipment and quality infrastructure for universal health coverage, monitors global health patterns, and seeks the most advanced plans for before, during and after an emergency while mitigating inequities to reach long-term health outcomes.

In alignment with the central theme of MUNMx' 26 Campus Hidalgo, "Sustainability and Indigenous Peoples" , the WHO highlights that global health is deeply tied to the environment and the legacy of Indigenous knowledge and practices that have sustained human communities for centuries. As Member States and the UN recognize traditional medicine and integrate it into the modern world, they connect these roots to the future, ensuring a sustainable and equitable development for present and upcoming generations.





health and well-being around the world.
An international organization that works to improve



Topic A

Global mental health crisis among adolescents and young people in the

digital era.

An international organization that works to improve health and well-being around the world.

Guiding Question

How can the international community address the global mental health crisis among adolescents and young people in the digital era?

The growing mental health crisis among adolescents in today's rapid development of the digital world involves increasing rates of anxiety, depression, low self-esteem, and self- harm. This issue is strongly tied to excessive screen time, cyberbullying, social media, digital platforms built to keep users hooked and cultural frameworks. Addressing this crisis is a major international priority under UN Sustainable development Goal 3 (Target 3.4), which aims to promote mental health and well-being while reducing premature mortality from non-communicable disease.

According to data from the WHO one in seven adolescents from 10 to 19 years old experience a mental disorder, depression, anxiety and behavioural disorders the leading causes among adolescents.

International bodies such as the WHO, UNICEF, UNESCO, the European Union , and the OECD are working actively on this challenge. However, member states face major debates regarding effective solutions. One central dilemma is whether governments should legally enforce “Safety by Design" rules on tech companies, or if primary responsibility lies with parents and individuals. Another challenge involves restringing fundamental human rights like freedom of expression and privacy. Finally, a severe public health gap remains: while digital access is expanding rapidly worldwide, low and middle income countries still face a critical shortage of mental health services to support young people in distress.





“There is no health without mental health.” — World Health Organization

Historical context

Since the 2000s, the rapid evolution of digital platforms, social media, and algorithms has reshaped human interaction, marking the historical origins of screen-induced psychological challenges among youth. Between 2010 and 2015, global indicators revealed a sharp rise in youth anxiety, depression, and suicidal ideation. This trend was severely exacerbated by the COVID-19 pandemic (2020-2022), as lockdowns forced education and social life online, worsening isolation, high screen time, and internet dependency.

For the reason of this crisis the World Health Organization (WHO) established the Comprehensive Mental Health Action Plan 2013-2030 to strengthen governance, preventive strategies, and research, alongside the Mental Health Gap Action Programme (mhGAP) to scale up care for neurological and mental disorders. Additionally, the WHO Special Initiative for Mental Health (2019-2023) aimed to ensure affordable and quality care worldwide.

Simultaneously, the European Union integrated youth wellbeing into its European Youth Strategy (2019- 2027) under Goal 5, while the COST EU program launched the YouthDMH action (2024-2028) to improve health outcomes through digital technology.

Together, these illustrate how technological advancement shifted from a developmental milestone into an urgent global health priority, requiring active multilateral response today.

Social media can expose young people to cyberbullying, social comparison, and excessive screen time, which can negatively affect their mental well-being.

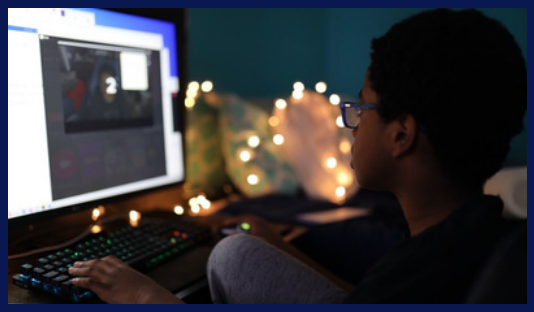




Measures

To address the growing mental crisis among young people, international organizations and research groups have developed several key frameworks. At the global policy level, the WHO guides government responses through its Comprehensive Mental Health Action Plan, which helps countries build better mental health services. To support local healthcare systems directly, the WHO and UNICEF launched joint guidance to improve mental health care for youth, showing governments how to provide community based support instead of relying on long-term hospital care. The United Nations works to make online environments safer through its Child and Youth Safety Online initiative, which focuses on preventing cyberbullying and holding tech platforms accountable. Finally, international projects like the Eu COST Action on Youth Digital Mental Health, bring together researchers, and young people to design safe and effective digital mental health tools.

These interactions raise awareness and set safety standards, but major challenges remain. Rapid tech developments, like AI, outspace legislation, while companies keep algorithms hidden. Crucially, low and middle income countries lack the financial and healthcare resources to turn these international guidelines into real mental services for youth.





"You are not alone. You are seen. I am with you." — Oprah Wi n f rey

Guide questions

1. Whatareyournation'spositions and official policy regarding teenagers's mental health?
2. What specific public health programs has your government implemented to address anxiety, depression or any other situation affecting their mental health?
3. How does your nation react to the need to protect young people from harms online while safeguarding their data and fundamental rights?
4. What national or international laws or regulations exist to protect the teenagers' exposition to content that is harmful for their mental health?
5. How could your nation cooperate in the creation of viable and sustainable solutions to this challenge?
6. Which member states of the UN share the same vision as your country regarding the topic presented?
7. How has the measurable data changed in your country according to teenagers' mental health before and after the pandemic and how that relates to WHO?
8. How does your government collaborate with non-governmental organizations in the protection and prevention of any mental health issue on teenagers?
9. What nationwide measures has your country presented for mental health emergencies such as channels or hotlines?
10. Does your government enforce the minimum age limits for social media use as a measure to avoid harmful exposition?



Topic B

Regulation and integration of Artificial Intelligence and genetic editing in health

An international organization that works to improve health and well-being around the world.

Guiding Question

How can the international community regulate and integrate artificial intelligence and genetic editing in healthcare while ensuring safety, ethics, and equal access?

Genetic editing is a massive phenomenon in health and technology. These technologies allow scientists to have the ability to change an organism's DNA by adding, removing or altering at a particular location in the genome. The integration of Artificial Intelligence into gen editing has become a powerful tool for developing safer and faster treatments. Even though they are really helpful they can be a danger to human beings if it does not establish global regulatory frameworks that

ensure the safe, ethical, and equitable deployment of This these convergent technologies. within topic holds vital significance the international framework, driven by the imperative to address bioethical concerns, protect global and stop expanding inequity, from worsening disparities healthcare divides.

The most known achievement is the CRISPR which consists in modifying specific points in the DNA. This powerful tool has been used for the creation of Casgevy therapy for sickle cell anemia and connects the first personalized therapy for a baby with a rare genetic disease. Global organizations like the World Health Organization (WHO), UNESCO, along with health agencies like the FDA, and EMA, are working to create shared rules. Key debates focus on allowing gene edits in regular body cells while banning edits passed to future generations, protecting patient privacy, and ensuring fair access for developing countries.





-“Science is a way of trying not to fool yourself.” — Richard Feynman

Historical context

With the first simple algorithmic models with thename of Artificial Intelligence created back in 1956, technology has experienced a rapid and transformative evolution. Initially the use of technology in medicine was mainly used as basic administrative or learning instruments, evolving gradually into more advanced and sophisticated systems that support diagnostics, modeling and data analysis.

However, this historical acceleration has resulted in an intense global debate regarding the technical and ethical implications of integrating Artificial Intelligence and genetic editing in medicine. While these tools offer thousands of opportunities for personalized treatment and disease detection, they also raise concerns about the the integrity, protection of data and accuracy of the same

Today, global health organizations emphasize that integrating emerging technology and innovation requires many processes and information to work. From legal framework to safe human rights and the right of use of it, WHO will always look for it to ensure equity across populations without damaging medical progress or human intervention on it.

AI can help doctors detect diseases through medical images, while genetic editing can help treat genetic disorders. However, these technologies must be regulated to protect patient data, human rights, and equal access to healthcare.

Measures

Various international and governmental entities have launched initiatives to regulate the convergence between artificial intelligence and gene editing. The World Health Organization has established frameworks to govern the use of these convergent technologies in public health. UNESCO has unanimously adopted The Universal Declaration on the Human Genome and Human Rights at the UNESCO's 29th General Conference on 11 November 1997, they believe it should be protected and passed on to future generations and that advances in science need to be considered in the light of human rights



Additionally, specific technical frameworks have been issued by national regulatory bodies to manage these tools. The U.S. FDA has established guidelines on Predetermined Change Control Plans (PCCP) to manage dynamic AI software, alongside standard protocols for safety assessment using Next- Generation Sequencing (NGS) to detect off- target gene edits. Furthermore, international alignment is progressing through joint FDA and EMA principles on AI in drug development.

Despite these advances in technical standardization for somatic treatments, current measures face significant limitations. The primary challenge is the absence of a legally binding international treaty to unify global governance. Furthermore, the rapid pace of generative AI frequently outpaces traditional regulatory frameworks, while limited technical and financial capacity in developing nations deepens gaps in equitable access.

"We need to start talking about mental health." — Prince Williamr

Guide questions

1. What isyour nation's general official stance on the use of AI and genetic editing in health?
2. What mechanisms has your country had locally or internationally about the ethical use of these technologies in medicine?
3. What are the main healthcare system challenges that your country faces?
4. How could technology help or affect the solution for the challenges there exist?
5. How does your government associate with non-governmental organizations, communities and population on these health issues?
6. How frequent and popular is genetic editing in your country and how has it been used?
7. How can your country help in supporting the WHO's ethical use of AI and guarantee safety for the population?
8. How much of the medical process from diagnosis to treatment is supported by AI or any kind of technology in your country?
9. Which member states share similar interests and perspectives with your nation and how?
10. In what ways does your country's current strategies integrate sustainability or how could they improve?

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